

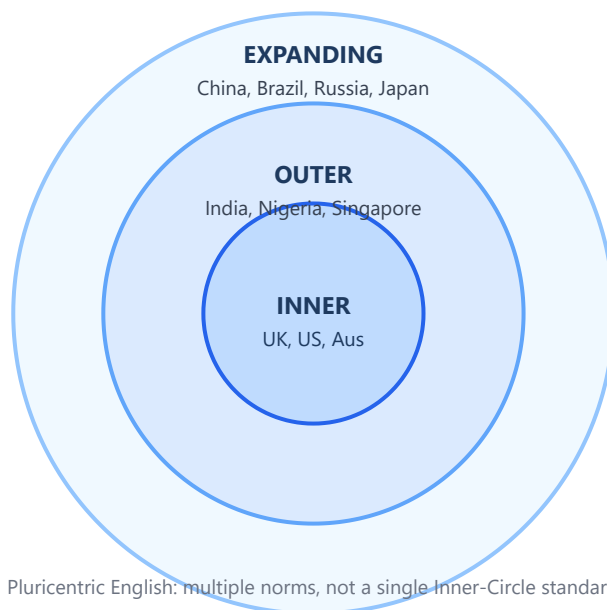
- RAG Learning

3.1 Global English (Paper 3 pathway)

Edexcel A-Level English Language (9EN0) — Paper 3 Investigating Language

Paper 3 asks you to study ONE of five research topics in depth and apply it to unseen texts in the exam. **Global English** investigates how English has spread as a global language and produced multiple "new Englishes" with their own legitimate norms. Key frameworks: **Kachru's Three Circles, Jenkins's ELF, Crystal's pluricentric English, Schneider's Dynamic Model, García's translinguaging.**

Kachru's Three Circles of World Englishes



3.1.1 Kachru's Three Circles

- **Inner Circle** — native English countries (UK, US, Canada, Australia, NZ). Traditionally "norm-providing".

- **Outer Circle** — English as institutionalised second language, often post-colonial (India, Nigeria, Singapore, Ghana, Kenya). Developing local norms.
- **Expanding Circle** — English as foreign / international language (China, Brazil, Russia, Japan). Increasingly developing local norms through ELF.

Criticism: risks Inner-Circle hegemony; many Expanding-Circle users are highly proficient; Outer-Circle varieties are pluricentric in their own right; boundaries blur.

3.1.2 Jenkins's ELF & Lingua Franca Core

Jennifer Jenkins argues that for communication between non-native speakers — the majority of global English use — Inner-Circle norms are not the relevant target. Her **Lingua Franca Core** identifies only certain phonological features as essential for intelligibility (consonant clusters, nuclear stress placement) while exact RP vowels are not. Implication: "correct" English in ELF contexts is defined by intelligibility, not native-speaker conformity.

3.1.3 Crystal and Pluricentric English

David Crystal argues that English's global spread has produced multiple **new Englishes**, each with legitimate norms. With roughly **1.5 billion speakers**, only about 390 million of them native (*Ethnologue*, 2025), the idea of a single "correct" English is incompatible with actual usage. His position is broadly descriptivist.

3.1.4 Schneider's Dynamic Model

Edgar Schneider (2007) described post-colonial Englishes as evolving through five stages:

1. **Foundation** — English arrives with colonisation; initial contact.
2. **Exonormative stabilisation** — Inner-Circle norm (British / American) remains dominant.
3. **Nativisation** — local features emerge and gain visibility.
4. **Endonormative stabilisation** — local norms codified (dictionaries, style guides).
5. **Differentiation** — internal variation within the local variety becomes salient.

Useful because it adds a DYNAMIC dimension missing from Kachru's static circles — tracks HOW post-colonial Englishes evolve.

3.1.5 García's Translanguaging

Ofelia García's concept of **translanguaging** treats multilingual speakers as having a single integrated repertoire deployed flexibly, rather than switching between bounded languages. Reframes "code-switching" and "code-mixing" as fluent use of one holistic resource — common in multilingual cities and schools. Educational implication: pedagogy that affirms all a learner's languages tends to outperform English-only instruction for multilingual students.

3.1.6 Varieties of World English — Snapshot

Variety	Key features
Indian English	"Prepone"; progressive with stative verbs ("I am understanding"); invariant tag "isn't it?"
Singlish	Final particles "lah", "lor", "meh"; topic-prominent syntax; Malay/Hokkien/Tamil/Cantonese influence
Nigerian English	"Go-slow" = traffic jam; distinctive modal use; Yoruba/Igbo/Hausa loans
Philippine English	"Comfort room" (toilet); Tagalog code-switching; stress patterns influenced by Tagalog
Australian English	"Arvo" (afternoon); "barbie" (barbecue); distinctive diphthongs
Caribbean / Jamaican Creole	"Mi" for "I"; copula deletion; aspectual markers
Hong Kong English	Code-switching with Cantonese; distinctive vowel merger; tonal influence
Chinglish	English influenced by Chinese grammar/lexis, seen in mainland signage and business

3.1.7 Pidgins, Creoles and the Llectal Continuum

- **Pidgin** — simplified contact language with no native speakers.
- **Creole** — pidgin acquired natively, with expanded grammar and lexis.
- **Decreolisation** — movement towards a prestige variety, producing a **lectal continuum** from basilect (furthest) through mesolect to acrolect (closest).

3.1.8 Ethnolinguistic Vitality — Giles

A variety's vitality depends on three factors:

- **Demographic strength** — number, density, concentration of speakers.
- **Institutional support** — education, media, government recognition.
- **Status** — economic and cultural prestige.

Low vitality correlates with language shift or death. Attitudes shape vitality — media, policy and education can reinforce or erode a variety.

3.1.9 Ownership of English

Henry Widdowson and Jennifer Jenkins both argue that English is "owned by no one" — it is a global resource shaped by all its users. This challenges the native/non-native binary and supports a pluricentric view. Implication: an Indian English speaker is not a "failed" speaker of British English but a legitimate user of Indian English.

3.1.10 Linguicide and Language Endangerment

UNESCO estimates about half of the world's 7,000 languages are endangered. Multiple factors contribute, including English's global role. However, factors such as colonisation, education policy and economic pressure usually do more direct work than English itself. Translanguaging and pluricentric Englishes often coexist with local languages rather than replacing them.

3.1.11 Attitudes and Ideology

Media representations of Outer-Circle Englishes in British press often show lingering colonial attitudes — exoticising or belittling local features. Such representations are linguistically unsupported (all rule-governed varieties are legitimate) but socially powerful. They are themselves useful data for a Paper 3 analysis.

Applied Example: A Nigerian political speech in English contains Yoruba-origin lexis, distinctive tag questions, and local idioms. A Paper 3 answer would: identify specific features; locate the variety in Kachru's Outer Circle; apply Schneider's Dynamic Model to position the speech historically; cite Crystal's pluricentric view; and evaluate how British-media framing of such speech tends to overlook linguistic legitimacy.

3.1.12 Analysing a Global English Text at A-Level

1. Identify the **variety** and its Kachru circle.
2. Analyse specific **features** at phonology, lexis, grammar and discourse levels.
3. Consider the **sociocultural context** — history, contact, identity.
4. Apply **theorists**: Kachru, Crystal, Jenkins, Schneider, García.
5. Discuss **attitudes** and representations — often ideological.
6. Evaluate with pluricentric awareness — avoid deficit framing.

Paper 3 Tip: Paper 3 rewards depth. Select named studies (2–3 theorists) and apply them PRECISELY to text features. Consider the variety, the text's context, and the evaluation of attitudes. Integration across phonology, lexis, grammar, pragmatics and discourse distinguishes top-band answers.

Key Terms Checklist

Make sure you can define: **Kachru's Three Circles (Inner/Outer/Expanding), ELF, Lingua Franca Core, Schneider's Dynamic Model (foundation → exonormative → nativisation → endonormative → differentiation), pluricentrism, new Englishes, translanguaging, code-switching / code-mixing, pidgin, creole, basilect / mesolect / acrolect, ethnolinguistic vitality, linguicide, standard-language ideology.** Theorists: **Kachru, Crystal, Jenkins, Schneider, García, Widdowson, Giles.**